PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS

HEAD START

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MEMO

Date: 07/08/2025

To: PPS School Board

From: Emily Glasgow, Senior Director of PK-5 Core Academics
Dana Stiles, Director of Early Learners (Head Start)

Subject: Head Start Action and Informational Items

BACKGROUND

A. Federal requirements call for the Governing Board of Head Start to approve recommendations and reports for the program.

B. The Board of Directors for Portland Public Schools serves as the Governing Board for PPS Head Start.

1. Updated Policy & Procedures

1.A. Safety Practices – PPS Early Learners (Head Start) has revised the Safety Practices Policy in alignment with Head Start Performance Standards §1302.47(a)(4) Achieving program goals, §1302.47(b)(7)(iii) Safety Practices, and §1302.74(a) Safety Procedures. PPS Early Learners incorporates a system of health and safety practices that ensures a safe, secure and healthy environment to support children's learning and development. PPS Early Learners Parent Policy Council approved this policy and procedure on May 14, 2025. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

1.B. Active Supervision – PPS Early Learners (Head Start) has revised the Active Supervision Policy in alignment with Head Start Performance Standards §1302.90 – Personnel policies. All staff and adults in our program are responsible for actively supervising children at all times in accordance with the program and district standards of conduct. PPS Early Learners Parent Policy Council approved this policy and procedure on May 14, 2025. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

1.C. Parent Activities – PPS Early Learners (Head Start) has revised the Parent Activities Policy in alignment with Head Start Performance Standards §1302.51 – parent activities to promote child learning and development. The program values parents as their child's first teacher and will work to promote shared responsibility with families for their children's early learning and development. PPS Early Learners Parent Policy Council approved this policy and procedure on May 14, 2025. Board approval of new

policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

1.D Classroom Coaching – PPS Early Learners (Head Start) has revised the Classroom Coaching Policy in alignment with Head Start Performance Standards §1302.92(c) – Training and professional development. The program implements a coordinated coaching plan for all education staff that assesses their strengths and needs and supports them in developing their skills and knowledge in order to provide high quality, comprehensive services to children and families. PPS Early Learners Parent Policy Council approved this policy and procedure on May 14, 2025. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

1.E. Fees – PPS Early Learners (Head Start) has revised the Fees Policy in alignment with Head Start Performance Standards §1302.18 – Fees. Our program provides comprehensive services to eligible children and families at no charge. We recognize that the need for early childhood services is often greatest among the priority populations, including children from low-income families, children with disabilities, and those facing other barriers to access. PPS Early Learners Parent Policy Council approved this policy and procedure on May 14, 2025. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

1.F Staff Training and Professional Development – PPS Early Learners (Head Start) has revised the Staff Training Policy in alignment with Head Start Performance Standards §1302.92(c) – Training and professional development. The program incorporates best practices for adult learners in our professional development to implement a systematic approach to staff training. Professional development includes onboarding, annual Preservice, regular training through the school year, and professional learning communities. PPS Early Learners Parent Policy Council approved this policy and procedure on May 14, 2025. Board approval of new policies/procedures is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

2. Application for Federal Grant Renewal

Board approval is required to apply for continuation of federal grant funds ($6,382,217) for Fiscal Year 2026. The Head Start Parent Policy Council approved PPS Head Start applying for these funds on July 16, 2025. The application is due August 1, 2025. The Federal Funding Guidance Letter is attached. Board approval is required. A Board Letter of Approval and Resolution are requested.

3. 2024 – 2025 PreK Black Excellence Comprehensive Plan

The interest in opening a PreK Black Excellence Classroom began several years ago. PPS Early Learners Department put together an equity-centered Design Team to plan for the opening of a PreK Black Excellence Classroom for the 2025-26 school year. Led by Black PPS Early Learners staff, the Design Team was tasked with creating a comprehensive plan for the classroom that meets the needs of our students and the community; the plan considers mission/vision, curricular resources, community partnerships, and family engagement. The PreK Black Excellence Classroom will open at Dr. Martin Luther King Jr School in the fall fully enrolled. The PreK Black Excellence Comprehensive Plan is attached. This report is for the Governing Body's information only. Governing Body approval is not required.

4. 2025 Community Needs Assessment – Executive Summary

Head Start requires programs to conduct a full community assessment that uses data to describe the community strengths, needs, and resources every five years. Annually, we review and update the assessment to inform program decision making year-to-year. This includes

reviewing data related to family and child homelessness, income eligibility, and the availability of publicly funded pre-kindergarten programs within the PPS boundaries. The 2025 Early Learners Community Needs Assessment Executive Summary is attached. This report is for the Governing Body's information only. Governing Body approval is not required.

RELATED POLICIES/BEST PRACTICES

Items listed above are required to be reviewed, updated, and/or approved by the Parent Policy Council and Governing Board.

ANALYSIS OF SITUATION

All items listed above support the high quality, comprehensive wraparound services provided to the children and families attending PPS Head Start.

FISCAL IMPACT

The items included in this packet do not have any significant direct impacts on program or district funding. Some items are required as part of grant agreements (federal, state, and city) in order to maintain current funding.

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council reviewed, provided input, and approved these actions/items at spring meetings noted above and reflected in the attached meeting minutes.

TIMELINE FOR IMPLEMENTATION / EVALUATION

The timeline for implementation was the 2024 – 2025 school year.

BOARD OPTIONS WITH ANALYSIS

Board approval needed.

CONNECTION TO BOARD GOALS

The goal of PPS Head Start is to prepare the city's diverse and resilient young children for successful transitions to kindergarten and beyond by leveraging each child's strengths, building their social competence, and developing school readiness skills.

In June 2022, the PPS School Board established a new set of goals. "It remains the core mission and responsibility of our school system to ensure that every student has opportunities to thrive and experience success. Unfortunately, too many students have been historically underserved, and there has not been evidence of racial equity in PPS as revealed by persistent gaps in student outcomes along the lines of race. We are dedicated to the continuous improvements necessary to drive the system shifts that will better support our students, educators, and leaders and result in improved student performance." The Board adopted the following four priorities for the 2022-2027 time period to move the school district toward the above aspirations:

- Improve Third Grade Reading achievement
- Improve Fifth Grade Mathematics achievement
- Improve Eighth Grade Readiness
- Improve High School Graduation rates

The above items support the district's and School Board's vision and priorities.

STAFF RECOMMENDATION

Develop Board resolutions and obtain signatures of approval of the Board Chair of the attached documents.

As a member of the PPS Executive Leadership Team, I have reviewed this staff report.

KJH (Initials)

ATTACHMENTS

A. Policy and Procedures
    a. Safety Practices Policy
    b. Active Supervision Policy
    c. Parent Activities Policy
    d. Classroom Coaching Policy
    e. Fees Policy
    f. Staff Training and Professional Development Policy
B. Policy and Procedures Board Approval Letter
    a. Safety Practices Policy
    b. Active Supervision Policy
    c. Parent Activities Policy
    d. Classroom Coaching Policy
    e. Fees Policy
    f. Staff Training and Professional Development Policy
C. Policy and Procedures Board Resolutions
    a. Safety Practices Policy
    b. Active Supervision Policy
    c. Parent Activities Policy
    d. Classroom Coaching Policy
    e. Fees Policy
    f. Staff Training and Professional Development Policy
D. 2025-2026 Federal Grant Guidance Letter
E. 2025-2026 Federal Grant Renewal Approval Letter
F. 2025-2026 Federal Grant Renewal Board Resolution
G. 2025-2026 PreK Black Excellence Classroom Comprehensive Plan
H. 2025 PPS Early Learners Community Needs Assessment – Executive Summary
I. 4.16.2025 PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council Meeting Minutes
J. 5.14.2025 PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council Meeting Minutes
K. 6.4.2025 PPS Head Start Parent Policy Council Meeting Minutes